



Decimals

NUMBERS WRITTEN IN DECIMAL FORM ARE CALLED DECIMAL NUMBERS OR, MORE SIMPLY, DECIMALS.

SEE ALSO

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Decimal numbers

In a decimal number, the digits to the left of the decimal point are whole numbers. The digits to the right of the decimal point are not whole numbers. The first digit to the right of the decimal point represents tenths, the second hundredths, and so on. These are called fractional parts.

whole number part is 1,234

fractional part is 56

1,234.56

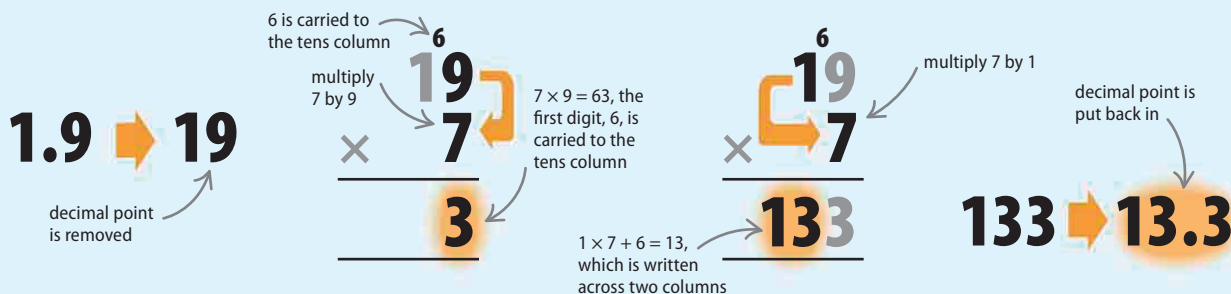
△ Whole and fractional parts

The whole numbers represent – moving left from the decimal point – ones, tens, hundreds, and thousands. The fractional numbers – moving right from the decimal place – are tenths then hundredths.

decimal point separates the whole numbers (on the left) from the fractional numbers (on the right)

Multiplication

To multiply decimals, first remove the decimal point. Then perform a long multiplication of the two numbers, before adding the decimal point back in to the answer. Here 1.9 (a decimal) is multiplied by 7 (a whole number).



First, remove any decimal points, so that both numbers can be treated as whole numbers.

Then multiply the two numbers, starting in the ones column. Carry ones to the tens if necessary.

Next multiply the tens. The product is 7, which, added to the carried 6, makes 13. Write this across two columns.

Finally, count the decimal digits in the original numbers – there is 1. The answer will also have 1 decimal digit.